

English Language · Easier paper

Real VCAA questions ranked by the published state results. Editable: type your answers straight into this PDF, save it, then mark yourself with the guide at the back.

Name _____ Date _____

73 marks

reading 15 min · writing 120 min

State average on these questions

41 / 73 (56%)

a student at the state average on every question

How to use this paper

1. Open each question with its blue link. It opens the official VCAA exam PDF at the right page. The question text isn't reproduced here because it is VCAA copyright (some exams include third-party material).
2. Answer in this file: click a bubble for multiple choice, and type in the boxes for written answers (long answers scroll inside the box). Methods and science working can be typed in plain text, e.g. $v = \sqrt{2gh} = 9.9 \text{ m/s}$.
3. Keep to the real time limits above, and don't look at the guide until you've finished.
4. Save with Ctrl/Cmd + S. Use a PDF app that supports forms: Adobe Acrobat Reader, Chrome, Edge, Firefox, macOS Preview or Xodo.
5. Mark yourself: in the guide at the back, tick each marking point you earned, enter your marks, and compare your total with the state average.

Why these questions

Every section is a real VCAA exam section. English sections can't be split question by question, because each is built around one text, so Sections A, B and C from the 2023, 2024 and 2025 exams were ranked by state average and this paper takes the best-scored version of each section. English results barely move between years, so the three English papers are close in difficulty. VCAA reports Sections B and C on a 0–15 scale, so the averages are doubled to match the 30 marks on the paper.

Sources

- [2024 English Language exam \(PDF\)](#) · [examiners' report](#)
- [2025 English Language exam \(PDF\)](#) · [examiners' report](#)

Section A – Short-answer questions (13 marks)

All questions refer to Text 1 in the insert of the 2024 exam. Open the insert and each question with the links.

Section A (13 marks)

2024 VCAA exam · Insert, Text 1 · [open in the official exam PDF \(p. 30\)](#) ↗

Text 1: a transcript of a podcast interview between a host and a sportsperson/disability advocate

Question 2. Using an example, explain how the host establishes the guest's contributions to society (metalanguage, line numbers). [\(p. 3 ↗\)](#) (2 marks)

Question 3. Identify one politeness strategy in the interaction and justify how it influences the tenor (metalanguage, line numbers). [\(p. 4 ↗\)](#) (2 marks)

Question 4. Explain how changes in function across the text reflect aspects of the situational context (Jakobson's functions, metalanguage, line numbers). [\(p. 4 ↗\)](#) (4 marks)

Question 5. Analyse how the participants' turn-taking strategies construct their individual identities and group membership (metalinguage, line numbers). (p. 5 ↗) (5 marks)

Section B – Analytical commentary (30 marks)

Write an analytical commentary on Text 2 in the insert of the 2024 exam: function, purpose and intent; situational and cultural context; register, tenor and audience; and relevant language features from at least two subsystems.

Section B (30 marks)

2024 VCAA exam · Section B · Question 6 · [open in the official exam PDF \(p. 6\)](#) ↗

Insert: [Text 2](#) ↗

Text 2: a web page (with an embedded spoken monologue) promoting a reconciliation program for schools

Analytical commentary on Text 2 (30 marks)

Section C – Essay (30 marks)

Write one essay on one of the three topics. Open the topic in the official exam for the exact wording and stimulus material.

Section C (30 marks)

2025 VCAA exam · Section C (choose one of Questions 6, 7, 8) · [open in the official exam PDF \(p. 14\)](#) ↗

Choose one topic.

1. **Question 6.** In contemporary Australia, language can increase both social separation and social equality: discuss. ([exact wording and stimulus, p. 14](#) ↗)
2. **Question 7.** Contemporary social changes and technologies have influenced language norms in Australia: discuss. ([exact wording and stimulus, p. 16](#) ↗)
3. **Question 8.** To what extent do non-standard varieties of Australian English support the construction of identity in the public domain? ([exact wording and stimulus, p. 18](#) ↗)

Essay (name the topic you chose) (30 marks)

Essay (name the topic you chose) continued

END OF PAPER

Marking guide follows

Stop here until you have finished the paper under exam conditions.

Marking guide

Section A – Short-answer questions (13 marks)

Section A (13 marks) · state average 6.7 / 13 (52%)

2024 VCAA exam · Insert, Text 1

Question 2 · Using an example, explain how the host establishes the guest's contributions to society (metalinguage, line numbers).

- ☐ An accurate, quoted example with line numbers and metalinguage (e.g. the declarative listing of domains, lines 21–24)
- ☐ Explains how it establishes the guest's contributions: the range of domains he has worked in, as framed by the host

Answer / notes: The listing of the domains the guest has moved through (sport, politics, healthcare, representation) in the host's declarative shows the breadth of his contribution. It has to be the host's language, not the guest describing himself.

State average 1.3 / 2 (65%); 46% scored full marks. Mark distribution: 0: 20% · 1: 34% · 2: 46%

Your mark: _____ / 2

Question 3 · Identify one politeness strategy in the interaction and justify how it influences the tenor (metalinguage, line numbers).

- ☐ Accurately identifies a positive or negative politeness strategy with an example and line number (e.g. thanking/complimenting, line 2)
- ☐ Explains how it shapes the tenor (e.g. warm, friendly yet professional, attending to face needs)

Answer / notes: Thanking the guest for joining (line 2) is positive politeness: it meets his positive face needs and sets a warm, respectful tenor. Name the strategy precisely and state the tenor it creates.

State average 1.3 / 2 (65%); 44% scored full marks. Mark distribution: 0: 13% · 1: 43% · 2: 44%

Your mark: _____ / 2

Question 4 · Explain how changes in function across the text reflect aspects of the situational context (Jakobson's functions, metalinguage, line numbers).

- ☐ Identifies a shift between two Jakobson functions (e.g. phatic to referential) with quoted evidence
- ☐ Links the shift to a named element of the situational context (setting, field, tenor, mode or audience)
- ☐ Uses metalinguage to show how the shift is made, not just that it happens
- ☐ Develops a second shift or explains the first in depth

Answer / notes: For example, the opening is phatic (greetings, thanks), then turns referential as the host sets up the guest's background for the podcast audience. Tie each shift to field, audience or mode.

State average 2.2 / 4 (55%); 12% scored full marks. Mark distribution: 0: 10% · 1: 16% · 2: 33% · 3: 29% · 4: 12%

Your mark: _____ / 4

Question 5 · Analyse how the participants' turn-taking strategies construct their individual identities and group membership (metalinguage, line numbers).

- ☐ A turn-taking strategy analysed with evidence (e.g. question–answer adjacency pairs to pass the floor)
- ☐ A second, different strategy analysed (e.g. rising intonation, fillers or fast tempo to hold or transfer the floor)
- ☐ The host's identity (e.g. podcaster, floor manager, fan) linked to his turn-taking
- ☐ The guest's identity (e.g. sports figure, advocate, entrepreneur) linked to his turn-taking
- ☐ Group membership in the wider community (e.g. shared fandom, community of innovators) explained

Answer / notes: Keep turn-taking separate from topic management. Strong answers used prosody (intonation, tempo) to show how the floor is held or ceded, and covered both speakers' identities and group membership.

State average 1.9 / 5 (38%); 0.9% scored full marks. Mark distribution: 0: 13% · 1: 23% · 2: 33% · 3: 23% · 4: 6% · 5: 0.9%

Your mark: _____ / 5

Section B – Analytical commentary (30 marks)

Section B (30 marks) · state average 16.8 / 30 (56%)

2024 VCAA exam · Section B · Question 6

Analytical commentary on Text 2

____ / 8 · Function(s), purpose(s) and intent(s), situational and cultural context, and register, tenor and audience are analysed accurately and specifically for this text

____ / 10 · Salient language features from at least two subsystems are analysed with quoted examples and line numbers, each explicitly linked to function, context or register

____ / 6 · Precise, accurate metalanguage throughout

____ / 6 · A coherent, sustained commentary (not a feature list), with clear, controlled expression

Answer / notes: Formal yet approachable register. Referential and conative functions (informing educators and urging them to engage), with emotive and poetic touches in the spoken monologue. Salient features: imperatives (“Join”, “Read”), hyperlinked noun phrases, listing of stakeholders, inclusive “we/together”, the Indigenous borrowing of the program name, and prosody (pauses) in the monologue. The multimodal text tripped many students up.

State average 16.8 / 30 (56%). VCAA reports this section on a 0–15 scale (doubled here to /30): 0: 0.5% · 1: 0.1% · 2: 0.3% · 3: 0.6% · 4: 1% · 5: 3% · 6: 8% · 7: 17% · 8: 24% · 9: 21% · 10: 13% · 11: 7% · 12: 4% · 13: 1% · 14: 0.2% · 15: 0.1%

Your mark: ____ / 30

Section C – Essay (30 marks)

Section C (30 marks) · state average 17.4 / 30 (58%)

2025 VCAA exam · Section C (choose one of Questions 6, 7, 8)

Essay (name the topic you chose)

____ / 8 · A clear, sustained and nuanced contention that answers the exact wording of the topic (including “to what extent” where asked)

____ / 10 · Relevant, contemporary Australian examples discussed in depth, drawing on at least two subsystems of language, with thoughtful use of the stimulus

____ / 6 · Accurate linguistic concepts and metalanguage

____ / 6 · Cohesive essay structure and fluent, controlled expression

Answer / notes: Address both halves of each topic (e.g. separation and equality; social change and technology). Avoid tokenistic or misattributed quotations from linguists. Topic choice across the state: Q6 48%, Q7 26%, Q8 26%.

State average 17.4 / 30 (58%). VCAA reports this section on a 0–15 scale (doubled here to /30): 0: 0.7% · 1: 0.1% · 2: 0.3% · 3: 0.4% · 4: 1% · 5: 3% · 6: 7% · 7: 14% · 8: 22% · 9: 20% · 10: 15% · 11: 8% · 12: 5% · 13: 2% · 14: 1% · 15: 0.4%

Your mark: ____ / 30

Your result

Total: _____ / 73 State average on these questions: **41 / 73 (56%)**

Topics to revise:

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